

"Khadi isn't just a cloth, it's a weapon of self-reliance"

Narendra Modi



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From 'Swadeshi Symbol' to 'Global Revolution'
The Khadi Renaissance under PM Modi's Leadership

Khadi, which was made the strongest weapon of struggle against British rule during the Swadeshi movement in the Indian freedom struggle by revered Bapu Ji, has evolved into a powerhouse of self-reliance India. In the last 9 years, under the visionary leadership of Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, **'the Sculptor of Modern India'**, 'the visionary of Aatmanirbhar Bharat' and **'the Pioneer of Viksit Bharat'**, the **'New Khadi of New India'** has been catapulted as the most powerful, capable and successful 'Astra and Shastra' (weapon) of poverty alleviation, artisan empowerment, food security, women empowerment and unemployment alleviation. By connecting India's rich Khadi legacy with the **'Guarantee of the Modi Government'**, business of Khadi and Village Industries **surpassed Rs. 1.34 lakh crore** in the last fiscal year with creation of **more than 9.37 lakh new jobs.**

During the recent 9th Handloom Day Celebrations at the prestigious 'Bharat Mandapam' in New Delhi, the Hon'ble PM presented a new picture of **'नये भारत की नई खादी -Guaranteed by the Modi government'** to the world. In his own words, he stated, "Khadi is not just a cloth, it is also a weapon of self-reliance." In essence, Khadi is an extension of the philosophy of Pujya Bapu, in which he had said, "Khadi is not just a cloth but an ideology."

'Khadi Movement' Revitalized with the 'Guarantee of the Modi Government'

From **Independence to Self-Reliance,** where Khadi once symbolized the pride of the national movement under the leadership of Pujya Bapu, today it stands as a symbol of pride under the visionary leadership of the Honorable Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi in the **'Aatmanirbhar and Viksit Bharat Campaign'**. Khadi is a traditional hand-woven and hand-spun durable fabric weaved by rural artisans. Gandhiji had envisioned Khadi as a means to give concrete expression to the 'Swadeshi spirit'. His idea was that villages can be made self-reliant through Khadi. Pre-independence, the development of Khadi was actually a non-governmental effort and Gandhiji had formed an autonomous organization called All India Charkha Sangha in the year 1925 to promote Khadi activities in the villages. Gandhiji believed that Khadi represents the indigenous spirit and is a means to unite Indians, achieve economic independence and equality. He believed that the soul of India lies in its villages and for the prosperity of India, it is necessary for these villages to prosper. Keeping this concept in mind, Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) was established in April 1957 by an Act of Parliament passed in 1956 after independence. Today, under the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises, Government of India, KVIC is playing a leading role in promoting Khadi and making rural India self-reliant through employment generation.

The neglect that our national pride Khadi faced after independence is well-known. Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi ji also expressed grief over the lack of proper recognition of rich Indian heritage and meted out Khadi at many forums both within the country and internationally. However, under his leadership and tireless efforts, Khadi has undergone a remarkable transformation, evolving into a **'Global Brand- Guaranteed by Modi Government'** within a span of just 9 years. It now stands as a potent 'Weapon' in the fight against poverty and for ensuring food security in the nation. According to NITI Aayog data, 13.5 crore people have come out of multidimensional poverty in India in the last 5 years. During the National Handloom Day celebrations, the Prime Minister highlighted the exponential growth of Khadi and Village Industries